

GLOSSARY

- adventure** — Any session where a DM and players meet to play a D&D game.
- alignment** — The general pattern of behavior of monsters and characters in D&D rules.
- area** (of effect) — The space and those objects and creatures within the space which are affected by the results of a spell, breath weapon, magical device and other attacks which can strike multiple targets.
- Armor Class** (or **AC**) — The armor worn by a character or the natural protection a monster has against missile and melee attacks.
- caller** — The player who normally tells the DM what his or her party will do, based on what the other players tell him or her.
- campaign** — A series of adventures taking place on the same fantasy world.
- character class** — The profession the player has chosen for his or her character in a game.
- character level** — see **experience level**.
- charge (magical)** — The magical energy needed to use a wand or staff once.
- class** — see **character class**.
- coin** (or **cn**) — A unit of weight and treasure in D&D rules.
- combat round** — A length of game time equal to 10 seconds used when combat occurs between players and monsters.
- concentration** — A character putting all his or her attention on an object or action, during which the character may do nothing else, and which, if distracted (attacked) will cause the concentration to be lost.
- cover** — Anything, besides a shield, that a character hides behind to gain protection from an attack.
- cn** — see **coins**.
- cp** — Copper pieces. There are 10 copper pieces to a silver piece.
- d*** (**d4**, **d6**, **d8**, **d10**, **d12**, **d20**, **d%**) — A symbol showing what type of die to roll. For example, a d20 is a twenty-sided die.
- damage roll** — The die roll to find how much damage an attack does.
- demi-human** — A human-like creature that is also a character class (elves, dwarves, and halflings).
- dungeon** — A place, underground and often among ruins, where characters adventure.
- dungeon level** — This refers to how far a dungeon area is below the ground, with the danger increasing with the depth of the level.
- Dungeon Master (DM)** — The referee who creates the dungeon, provides the setting for the game, and handles all monsters encountered.
- duration** — The length of time an effect lasts, given in combat rounds, game turns, or game days.
- enchanted monster** — A monster created, conjured, or animated by magic. This includes normal monsters summoned by spells or magic items, but does not include mental summons (like the animals called by lycanthropes). Enchanted monsters in the D&D BASIC rules are skeletons, zombies, and living statues.
- encounter** — A meeting between player characters and monsters.
- encumbrance** — The equipment, treasure, and other burdens carried by a character given in one pound equal to 10 coins.
- ep** — Electrum pieces. There are 2 electrum pieces per gold piece.
- evasion** — An attempt to get away from a monster or avoid an encounter.
- experience level** — An indication of the power and ability of a character.
- experience points** (or **XP**) — Awards given to characters representing improvements in abilities and skills through adventuring.
- fighting withdrawal** — Backing up slowly while trading blows with an opponent.
- game turn** — Ten minutes of game time, often used to measure the time spent moving through or exploring an area.
- gp** — Gold piece. The basic unit of money in a D&D campaign.
- hit dice** — The number of dice rolled to find how many hit points a character or monster has, the type of die used dependent upon the creature or class.
- hit points** (or **hp**) — The amount of damage a character or monster can sustain before dying.
- infravision** — A kind of "sight" that allows the possessor to see in darkness to a limited range.
- initiative** — A die roll to determine which side may act first in a combat situation.
- key** — Information used by the DM that describes and locates anything in a dungeon.
- lair** — The place where a monster lives.
- level** — see **character level**, **dungeon level**, **experience level**, **monster level**, and **spell level**.
- game time** — Imaginary time within the game spent by characters doing actions, not equal to actual time spent by the players.
- magical monster** (or **fantastic creature**) — Creatures which are "impossible" combinations (harpy) or those creatures with magical powers (doppelgangers or dragons), although giant animals and **enchanted monsters** are not the same as magical monsters.
- melee** — Physical combat that occurs when opponents are within 5' of each other using hand-held weapons and claws and teeth.
- missile fire** — Attacks at opponents more than 5' away, not including breath weapons or spell attacks using thrown and shot weapons.
- module** — Completely designed and challenging adventures available from TSR Hobbies, Inc. that contain maps, keys, background information, NPCs, and other information for use by the DM to use in his or her campaign.
- monster** — Any creature or character not controlled by a player.
- monster level** — A measure of how tough a monster is, usually equal to the number of hit dice the creature has.
- morale** — The willingness of a creature or character to face danger.
- nocturnal** — A word used to describe creatures that are active at night, in darkness or in dark underground areas.
- NPC** (or **non-player character**) — Any character that is controlled by the DM, other than player characters who have the misfortune of being temporarily charmed, confused, or deluded.
- party** — A group of characters or creatures who join together for adventure or a common purpose.
- percentage dice** (or **d%**) — d10 is used to roll a number from 1 to 100, where the first die roll is read as the tens and the second die is the ones.
- person (charm or hold)** — Humans, demi-humans, and human-like creatures such as bugbears, gnolls, goblins, hobgoblins, kobolds, lizard men, ogres, orcs, pixies, or sprites.
- player balance** — The matching of challenges to characters with their abilities and the rewards, to provide an exciting game without making it too easy for players to succeed or too hard to survive.
- player character** (or **PC**) — A character that is controlled by a player all the time (not an NPC).
- pole arm** — Any of several two-handed medieval weapons consisting of a blade or point fixed to a 5 to 12 foot pole. Typical pole arms are halberds, pikes, glaives, or bill hooks.
- pp** — Platinum piece. A platinum piece equals 5 gold pieces.
- prime requisite** — The ability that is most important to a given character class.
- quarrel** — A short, heavy shaft that is shot from a crossbow (also called a bolt).
- range** — The maximum distance at which an attack may be made